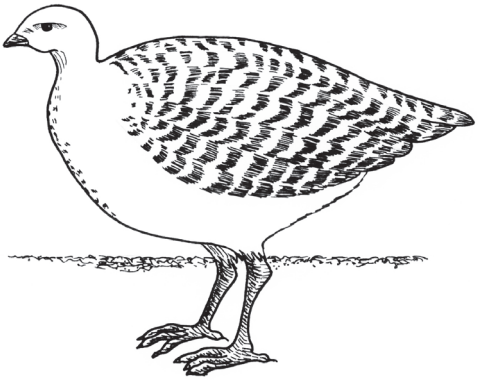
The malleefowl



The malleefowl is an Australian ground-dwelling bird. They are shy, solitary birds who only come together to mate. The male malleefowl digs a big hole in the ground and fills it with organic material such as sticks, bark and leaves. He then waits for rain. Once the organic matter is damp, he covers it with a thick layer of sand. The organic matter begins to decompose and generates heat. Every day the male checks the mound's temperature by poking his bill into it. When it is warm enough, the female lays her eggs inside the mound. Then she leaves the site and the male bird tends the mound daily, maintaining the internal temperature at 33°C. He does this by scraping away or adding the insulating sand.

The eggs take 7–9 weeks to incubate. By this time the male bird has stopped maintaining the mound and has left the hatchlings to fend for themselves. The chicks hatch inside the mound and struggle their way out of the sand. They never know their parents.

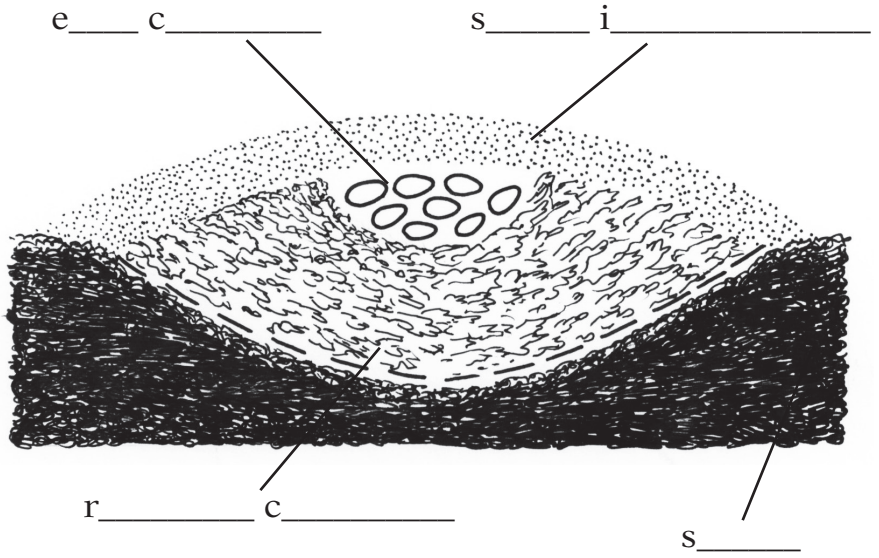
☞ **1** Read the text above, then underline the part that describes how the nest warms up.

2 Circle the temperature the nest needs to be kept at while the eggs incubate.

3 List the materials the male malleefowl uses to make his nest. _____

_____

4 Use the word bank to label the diagram.



Word bank

egg chamber
soil
rotting compost
sand insulation

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